Marco Carenza

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A Systems, Quest, and Level Designer, practiced in both leadership and traditional roles. I love working with spreadsheets and designing tactical combat and play.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

New York University Major Studio Fall - Teacher Assistant Sep 2026 - Dec 2026

- Responsible for administrative duties including attendance, and checking assignment submissions
- Assisted students with classwork and homework during school hours, while providing critical feedback

The List, Local No. 12 - Level Designer Jul 2026 - Oct 2026

- Researched and filtered through hundreds of topics for level implementation.
- Designed and implemented 80+ levels using in-house engines.
- Created and maintained spreadsheet that managed all game data, later transferred into the engine.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Untitled Quilting Game - System, Level Designer Sep 2026 - May 2027

- Designed and playtested player to NPC dialogue systems, ensuring that player choices impact narrative.
- Sketched, modified and made blockout of the main level of the game, ensuring good flow and clear topology.

Frozen Heart - Lead designer, Level Designer, Producer, Programmer Feb 2026 - May 2026

- Led a 3 person team by helping concepting, scope, and delivery of the game.
- Facilitated brainstorming, communication between team members, and project roadmap.
- Implemented all gameplay features, level design, and enemy AI in Unreal engine 5 with blueprints**.**

Gears of War Fan TTRPG - Game, System, Quest Designer Nov 2024 - May 2025

- Solo designed an unofficial Tabletop Roleplaying Game based on the Gears of War franchise (Xbox Game Studios) with a 62.8% View to Download rate on Itch.io.
- Developed systems to enhance the gameplay experience through mechanics and progression.
- Utilized numerical analysis and data interpretation to accurately assess dice success probabilities.
- Wrote and published a starting adventure and a campaign module.

Beyond Bounds (CERN Project) - Lead Game Designer, Producer Feb 2024 - Jun 2024

- Created a scientifically accurate board game related to space travel. Guided project and 12 person team of students in designing the experience in accordance with CERN's goals.
- Designed and implemented both gameplay systems and narrative elements.

RELATED COURSEWORK

Game Design-

- Developed creative production skills, including prototyping, playtesting and iterating, communication and documentation, what motivates people to play and what they find fun or meaningful.
- Learned to productively work together to make something new & communicate ideas. Using visuals and text to clearly present concepts and designs, though pitch decks & game design documents.

EDUCATION

MASTER OF FINE ARTS Game Design Sep 2025 - May 2027

New York University (NYU), New York, Brooklyn

SKILLS

- Unreal Engine 5, Unity, Godot
- Miro, Jira, Trello, MS Excel
- Twine, Obsidian
- Illustrator, Photoshop
- Machinations
- Maya, Blender, Substance 3D Painter
- Canva, AdobeXD
- Bilingual in English & Italian